PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
School District No. 1J, Multnomah County
Board of Education

February 23, 2026
Policy Committee Meeting

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Policy Committee Meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at the Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center (501 N Dixon St. Portland, OR 97227) and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Committee Members: Vice-Chair Michelle DePass (Committee Chair), and Directors Rashelle Chase-Miller and Stephanie Engelsman

Board Members (Non-Committee): Chair Eddie Wang and Director Patte Sullivan

Other Attendees:
Chris Buehler – Teacher
Emily Courtnage – Senior Legal Counsel
Hana Fares – Student
Sneha Goel – Student
Everett Paterson – Student
Rosanne Powell – Senior Board Manager
Alex Stegner – Teacher
Ben Switzer – Student
Della Sweeney – Student
Sharon Toncray – Chief Legal Officer

Call to Order and Introductions

The meeting was called to order at 4:31 pm by Committee Chair Michelle DePass.

Public Comment

- Mandy Green: Stated support for policies that address air pollutants
- Kelsey Furuta: Stated she would like environmental health policy additions to the Climate Policy.
- Alicia Cohen: Gave testimony about air quality
- Amy Ferriell: Gave testimony in support revising policies that would impact air quality
- Celeste Lewis: Would like for Portland Public Schools (PPS) to stop cooling schools with diesel air conditioners

Students For Peace Policy Proposal (proposed by students)

Director Wang shared that he and Director Sullivan had met with a group of students at Lincoln High School who had formed a group called "Students for Peace". The students provided testimony on their proposed policy in response to the District's AD on Political Speech, which resulted in Palestinian flags being removed from the school. They expressed sentiment that it felt like a targeted political issue. They shared examples of where other materials deemed political speech were allowed to remain posted.

Board Members expressed appreciation for the students who brought forth the policy proposal. Director Engelsman asked if any legal review of the policy proposal had taken place. Committee Chair DePass suggested asking the legal team to review the proposed policy, before scheduling it to come back to the Committee for further discussion and consideration. Director Wang asked if the Committee could also discuss banned symbols at that time. Sharon Toncray responded that she would work with the students.

Review Proposed Revisions to the Public Contracting Rules

Emily Courtnage shared proposed changes to the Public Contracting Rules. These changes included removing the duplicative amendment reporting requirements for contracts with amendments of 125% or more over the initial contract amount, as these already require Board approval and to bring the Offer of Judgment Rule into Alignment with Board Policy on Liability Claims, which allows the Superintendent to settle up to $75,000 without extra reporting.

Director Engelsman requested data on amendments between 100% and 124% of initial contract amounts. The Committee referred the proposed policy to the full Board for a First Reading at the March 10 board meeting.

Review of 7.00.000 Community Policies

Committee Chair DePass requested that Committee members review the 7.00.000 Community Policies and be prepared to discuss at the next meeting.

Other Business and Future Agenda Items

Director Engelsman stated she is okay with the suggested use of shall and will in policy language moving forward. She would like to add in a section about the language at the front of policies.

Adjournment

The meeting was adjourned at 5:53 pm by Committee Chair Michelle DePass.

Submitted by:

Kara Bradshaw
Executive Assistant / Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools